

THE WISH

[Shot handheld, on Camcorder]

EXT. VARIOUS ANYWHERE'S - DAY

A handful of early teen aged boys succumb to mischief on a boring summer afternoon in an anonymous New England suburb. They each have an indifference and curiosity that are balanced in fragile tension that necessitates one force eventually rupturing the other. The boys are gangly, but graceful. Each unassuming and tidier than slovenly. They are not punkish nor nerdy, they are their own sort of breed of brooding but bashful. Perhaps even frightened of something in the world or in themselves. They are all brunette, save the smartest and most captivating - this is COOPER (blonde).

They make their way through streets and engage in various activities of vague cruelty, tender foolhardiness, and the kind of creativity inspired by slates that look blank to the naked eye. It is impossible to describe in detail here what it is exactly they do or say or what it looks like as they move about uninhibited by observation. As if no one were watching this, except their own selves during some late night in the future, played back in miniature and casting fuzzy blue light across empty basements underneath sleeping parents.

One could guess or imagine that there are skateboards, small animals manhandled or chased, pranks pulled, heights scaled or descended rapidly. There are fragile erotic threads, there is a deeply entrenched competitive mode, there are pretty and expressionless faces.

EXT. FOREST PATCH - LATE AFTERNOON

One of the brunette boys rhythmically picks up and drops an ax into the dirt around a small cluster of trees at the edge of a slightly overgrown, very greeneried lawn. Another of the brunettes sits in the grass, tearing it up absentmindedly while staring off ten thousand miles or more into the distance. Cooper wriggles around through the brush, perhaps in some unprovoked imitation of a worm that everyone is ignoring. Once the pattern of ax thrumping dirt is auditorily established, the kid drops the weapon accidentally on Cooper's head. They get this on camera before dropping it to the ground in panic.

[CUT TO: A static wide shot of the same scene, now more handsomely composed and digital - crisp]

The ax is cleaved into Cooper's head and he is laying face down in dirt in the forest patch. Blood is splurting bombastically and erratically. For a brief moment, the others are motionless too, before they both immediately and tacitly agree to flee and do so with frenetic, overlapping movements.

Cooper lays in his pooling blood as we hold patiently on him and the light begins to change. It is summer and the sun sets slowly. As it does so, meanderingly, a faint outline of an opaque figure composed of light appears just barely - almost imperceptibly. (Think - a James Turrell transition). As the sunlight shifts, the figure comes into greater solidity although the color changes (also incredibly slowly) in some sort of complementary relationship to the environment. It is a human-like figure with a large, erect cock, which it strokes patiently. It deliberately steps towards the dying boy. When it reaches the spot between his splayed legs, it gets down on its knees and mounts Cooper.

At the exact moment the figure (allegedly) enters him, Cooper lifts his head up, pulling the ax through his wound, gasps, and throws his eyes open.

EXT. SOME STREET - DUSK

"Place To Be" by Nick Drake plays over:

Cooper wobbles down the street, zig zagging in and out of cones of light cast by street lamps. The figure follows him, almost pleadingly. Close on his heels, like a puppy.

His walk is arduous and bloody.

EXT. COOPER'S YARD - NIGHT

Summoning his strength for this last stretch, Cooper limps up the yard, the figure close behind. Cooper is weeping harder as he goes along, blubbering when he at last arrives at his doorstep. He enters the home, collapsing across the threshold, and closes the door behind him. The figure stands facing the closed door a moment, then disappears unceremoniously.

THE END